

your app and the social networking platforms, which can make your app feel more familiar and trusted. If you add something as simple as a 'like button', it'll let users appreciate your app and its content within their circles. Their friends, in turn, see the recommendation, click through your app, and some of them will 'like' or even 'tweet' (by using the 'tweet button' plugin) the same content. This will gradually snowball into a considerable rise in the number of users, which in turn will improve the overall 'social experience' of your app. Moreover, if your app is built around a business model, the increase in the number of users and higher user engagement will surely map to better revenues for you.

How to make your apps social

Platforms such as Facebook, Google Plus and Twitter have extensive developer sections, which can escort you towards making your apps as social as you want them to be. Apps can be made social in primarily two ways: Either you can use social plugins and channels to give a social layer to your app or you can use the social networking platform of your choice as the base and build your app over it. The two approaches are meant for entirely different kinds of usage, and choosing between the two depends on the nature of your problem that your app solves.

Add a social layer

This is a widely used approach and is suitable for existing web and mobile apps or those that aren't driven primarily by data originating from a social networking platform. Here you can effortlessly choose the social platforms you want to work with, go to their developer pages, build your desired plugins and paste the generated code snippets inside your app. It's really as simple as that! Twitter's 'tweet button' is a great example of a 'build-and-play' social plugin.

If you like it a little more advanced, you can hook your app to their APIs that provide access to the social graph of your users.

Data rendered by social networking APIs are usually high in quality and natively personalised in nature. With consent, you can pull your users' preferences and information from their social graph via the APIs, and logically use that information to personalise the content or components of your app. For example, using the APIs, your app can get to know what artists a user listens to. Then it can compute insights about the user's preference of music and highlight a certain area of your app in response, which would have a high probability being relevant to the user.

In addition to accessing information, you can publish customised notifications to the social platform in response to the actions taken

*pointers

>>Nuggets of cool code at work



*Mobile Web Developer Toolkit

>>Building for mobile web requires a different mindset than desktop web development, and a different set of tools. The tools we're used to using often aren't available or would take up too much screen real estate.

<http://dvwix.in/Zf1lpd>



*HTML5 faster?

>>After Facebook's Mark Zuckerberg expressed his dissatisfaction over their HTML5 experience, engineers at Sencha decided to prove him wrong, and went ahead and released an HTML5 based app that performs faster than native apps.

<http://dvwix.in/U5XFks>



*Become a developer

>>Fernando Ferrer shares insight on what it takes to be a software developer, whether you need to be a specialist or a jack-of-all-trades. Software developers are currently the most sought after resources in the US, according to reports.

<http://dvwix.in/12xrm0J>



*Adobe and Typography

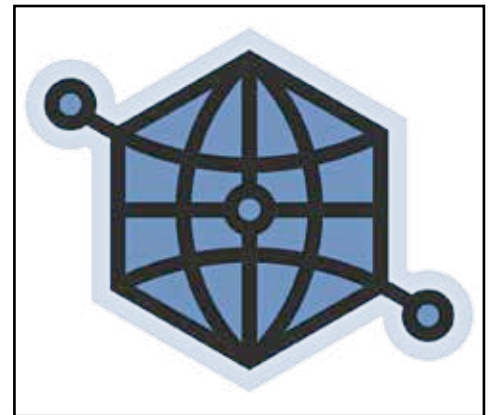
>>At the Create the Web Keynote in San Francisco (September 24th, 2012), Jeffrey Veen gives an overview of Edge Web Fonts.

<http://dvwix.in/UGTx7Y>

by the users inside your app. Facebook's 'login button', which allows your users to log in using their Facebook credentials or session, is a great example of how useful social plugins can be.

Building your app inside a social platform

Major social platforms such as Facebook and Google+ provide you with resources, free space and deep access to their social graphs, so that you can showcase your creativity by building your apps from within their website. With this approach, you can deeply integrate with the platform's core user experience and core platform technologies will be available for the app to hack into. It is meant for apps that are specifically meant to tap into the power of the targeted social networking platform.



You can build creative apps, even games inside these platforms, while offering full range of social networking capabilities to the users.

So should I let my apps socialise?

It's worth noting that social APIs are highly progressive in nature and you might need to update your apps according to the changes in their policies and protocols every once in a while. Nevertheless, from a developer point of view, it's one of the biggest thing to have happened to apps in recent times. Even giants like Apple have taken the social path, by 'deeply integrating' Facebook into their latest version of iOS. The manner in which social networking features are capable of enhancing your apps' overall user experience and capabilities, it easily surpasses any bottleneck that might come with it. With the power of social networking, you can tap into unexplored networking potential waiting in your apps, while making sure that you add value to your users, your apps and yourself! >

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